

2x2 Prioritisation Matrix

Prioritise ideas on two axes (e.g. impact vs effort)

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

A 2x2 matrix ranks options along two chosen dimensions — commonly **impact** and **effort** — producing four quadrants (e.g. quick wins, big bets, fill-ins, time-sinks). It converts a long, flat list of ideas into a visual prioritisation everyone can see and debate.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A generic strategy tool with many parents (BCG growth-share matrix, Eisenhower matrix); a facilitation staple across design and product practice.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Teams need a fast, defensible way to decide what to pursue first. Two axes force explicit trade-off criteria instead of gut feeling.

FIGURE 1 · IMPACT × EFFORT

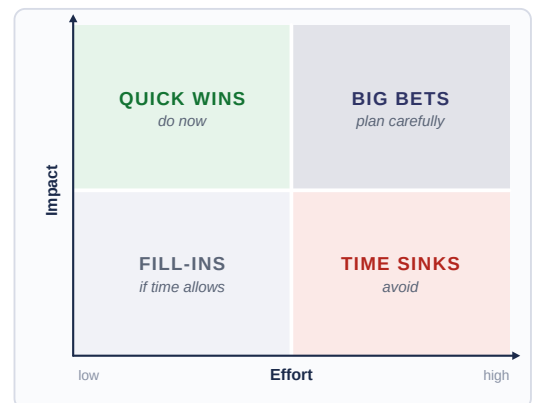


Figure 1. The common impact–effort version: quick wins first, big bets planned, time sinks avoided.

HOW IT IS USED

Choose two decision-relevant axes, plot each idea, then act on the favourable quadrant first (typically high-impact, low-effort 'quick wins').

WHEN IT IS USED

Convergence after ideation, and roadmap or backlog prioritisation.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Product managers, facilitators and leadership teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO PRIOR PRACTICE

Its power is **simplicity**: any two criteria that matter can be made visible and comparable at a glance, complementing dot voting for convergence.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Dot Voting *Slibrary 2*

Brainstorming *Slibrary 7*

Define Success *Slibrary 10*

SOURCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Gray, D., Brown, S. and Macanufo, J. (2010) *Gamestorming*. Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly.

Lewrick, M., Link, P. and Leifer, L. (2020) *The Design Thinking Toolbox*. Hoboken, NJ: Wiley.